

Implementation Presentation

Project MARIA

Group Composition and Roles

Ananaya Bhatnagar
Project Manager

Jorge Iriarte
Scrum Master

Lucy Hennessey
Developer

Joseph Casciato
Graphic Designer

Addison Connor
Journalist

Kate Siavel
Project Partner

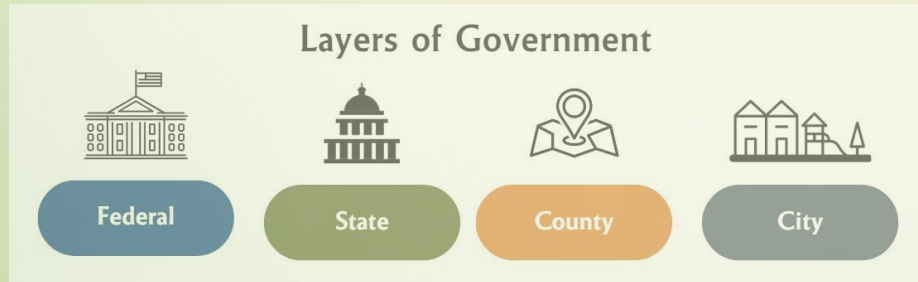
Problem

Imagine if you had to start over in another country?



Problem

- Over **20% of U.S. businesses are started by immigrants** ([ITIF](#))
- Yet they face **more difficulty accessing funding and resources** ([FED SB](#))
- Language barriers and system complexity make the process overwhelming
- Many rely on others instead of navigating independently ([WSJ](#))
 - Clear need for **simplified, accessible business guidance**



The Solution

- **Kate** is an **Immigrant** from Peru and Kent State Alumna who started her own business in the United States
- **Project MARIA** is the platform she is creating that helps **simplify** the process of starting a business in the US as an immigrant
 - It connects users with **resources** such as chatbots, articles, videos, and most importantly trusted partners to help **create LLCs** and **open business bank accounts.**

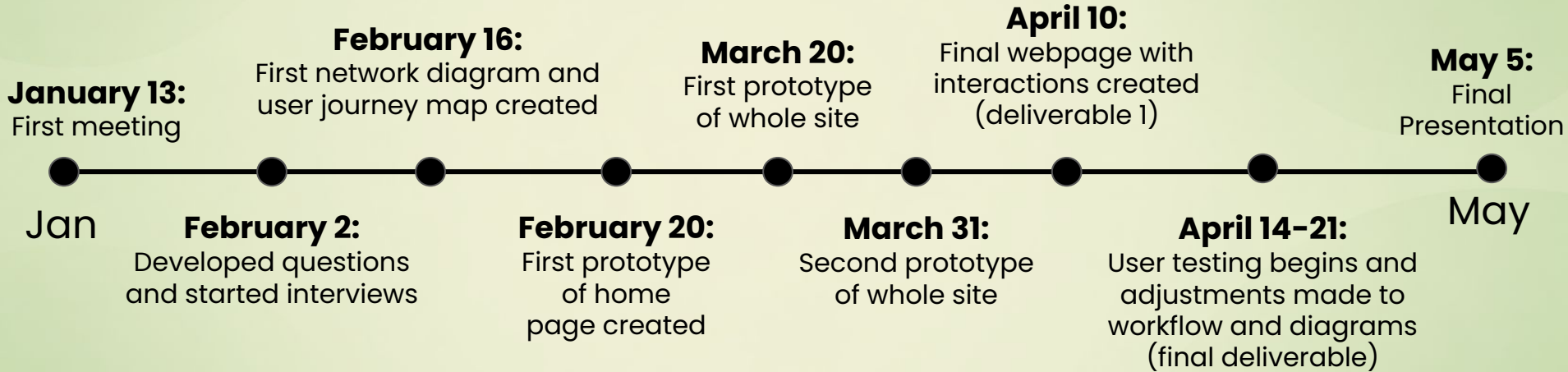


Our role

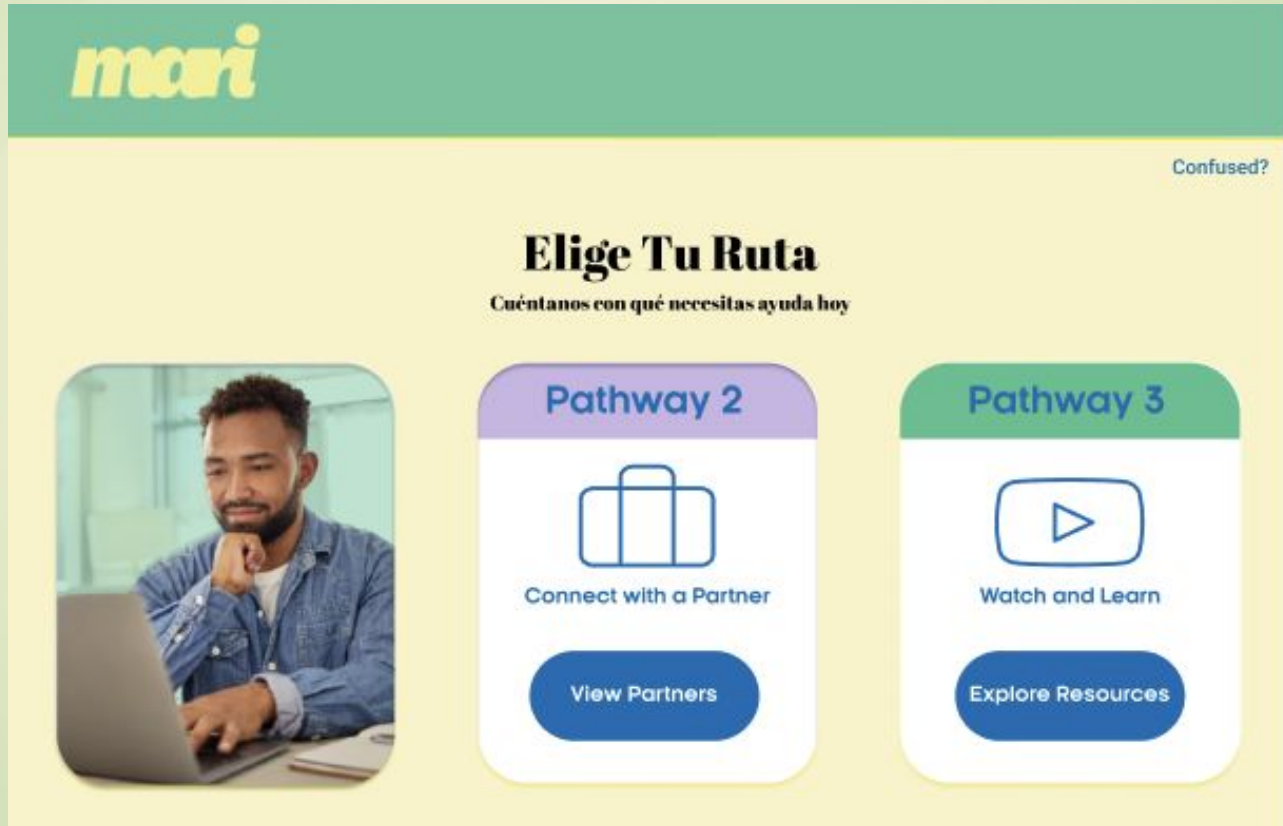
Our group was tasked with creating:

- A useable, testable workflow of the potential site that incorporates partners, resources, videos, and an AI ChatBot
- A user journey map
- A network diagram/site map

Deliverable Timeline



Where we started... (february 16)



In the middle... (march 20)



The screenshot shows the Project MARIA website. At the top, there's a navigation bar with the 'maria' logo and links for Home, About, Contact, and a dropdown menu for 'Services' containing 'Newcomer', 'Immigrant', and 'Entrepreneur'. Below the navigation bar, a yellow banner reads 'For Immigrant entrepreneurs'. The main heading is 'Start with *clarity.*'. Below this, a paragraph explains that Project MARIA helps immigrants and first-time entrepreneurs understand the process of starting a business in the U.S. and encourages asking Maria questions, exploring trusted partners, and learning steps before spending money on professional services. There are two buttons: 'Start' and 'Learn More'. At the bottom, a green section titled 'How Project MARIA helps you' features three numbered steps in colored boxes: 1. Ask Maria (Free), 2. Use Trusted Partners, and 3. Set Up Your Business.

maria

Home About Contact Services
Newcomer Immigrant Entrepreneur

For Immigrant entrepreneurs

Start with *clarity.*

Thinking about starting a business but feeling overwhelmed? Project MARIA helps immigrants and first-time entrepreneurs understand the process of starting a business in the U.S. Ask Maria questions, explore trusted partners, and learn the steps before spending money on professional services.

Start Learn More

How Project MARIA helps you

- 1. Ask Maria (Free)**
Get free guidance and understand your options before spending money.
- 2. Use Trusted Partners**
Work with approved services to form your LLC (paid).
- 3. Set Up Your Business**
Open a bank account and get everything ready to launch.

What is *Project MARIA*

Project MARIA is designed to help immigrants and first-time entrepreneurs start a business in the United States. Starting a business can feel overwhelming—especially when you don't know where to begin or who to trust. Maria simplifies the process by combining free AI guidance, trusted partners, and helpful resources all in one place.

Meet *Kate*



I am a Kent State business graduate and founder of my own real estate company.

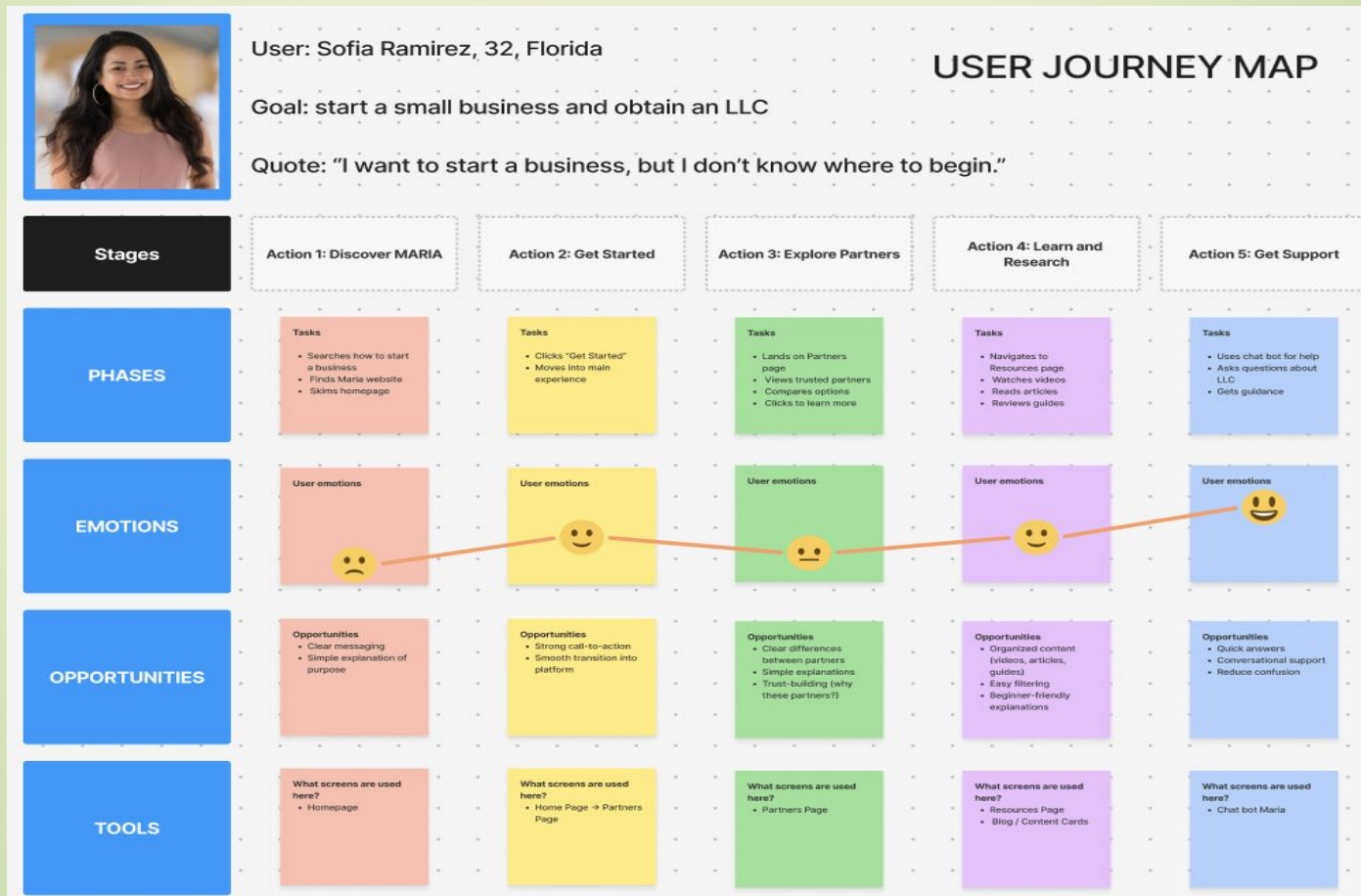
I know firsthand how overwhelming it can feel to start a business, especially as an immigrant navigating a new system without clear guidance.

Project MARIA was created to make that process easier by offering clear steps, trusted resources, and support to help you move forward with confidence.

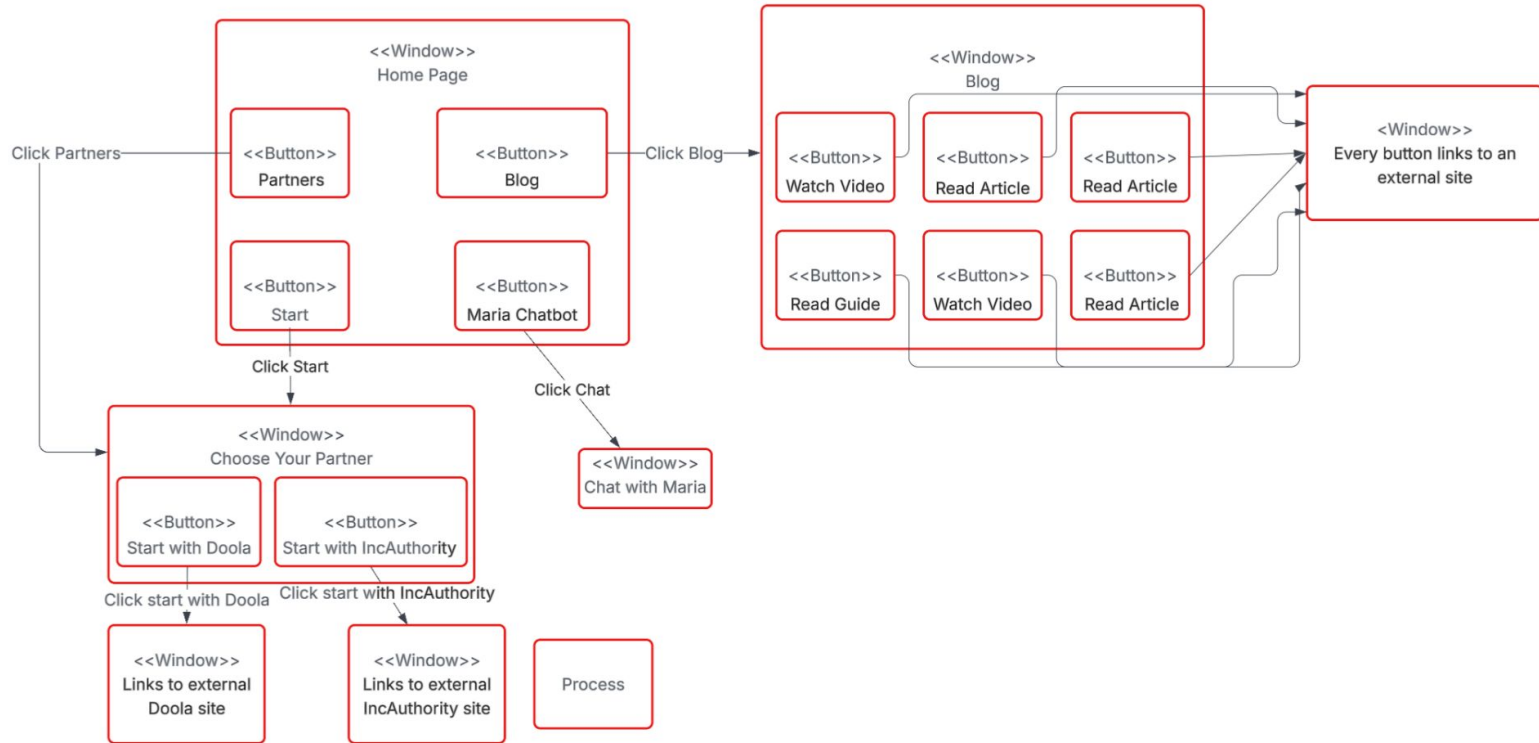
Deliverable 1: Final Webpage



Deliverable 4: User Journey Map



Deliverable 3: Updated Network Diagram



Testing Results

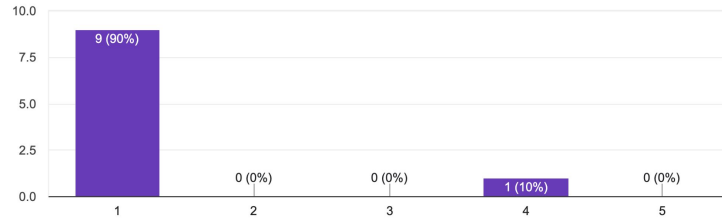
Timestamp	Native Language	Now that you have accessed the website, tell us	Task 1 - Find how you would start the process Question - The task was easy to accomplish	Task 2 - Find where you would go to learn more Question - The task was easy to accomplish
4/14/2026 19:37:17	Hindi	Get your LLC	1	1
4/14/2026 19:37:56	English	For helping establish businesses but catered to immigrants	1	1
4/20/2026 9:41:35	English	Helps people who speak english or spanish create businesses	4	4
4/21/2026 16:36:31	Spanish	It helps you to start a business	1	3
4/21/2026 16:46:52	English	To create an LLC	1	1
4/21/2026 17:04:49	English	Creating an LLC	1	1
4/21/2026 17:04:52	Spanish	LLC	1	2
4/21/2026 17:53:10	Arabic	Allowing diverse groups to make connections and create businesses	1	1
4/21/2026 18:12:08	English	Helps Immigrants find resource to open LLCs	1	1
4/21/2026 18:12:48	English	Getting immigrant entrepreneurs on track with the process	1	2

How did the information on the site feel—easy to understand, balanced text, etc.	Do you feel confident using this platform, and why?	Do you have any other suggestions?
Easy to understand. Balanced text.	I think so.	Contact us info if it matters.
I felt everything was easy and approachable. Non-English speakers would find it helpful.	I would! I really enjoy the layout. The flow is natural.	I think it's a great start! The only thing I would change would be on the partners page the yellow text on the green background is a little difficult to read.
Easy to understand	Yes so confident	
Easy	Yes, look trustable.	No
Easy to understand	Yes I would the layout is user friendly!	No
Easy to understand	Yes	Na
Easy to understand	Yes	Not at this moment
Easy to understand	I felt confident, yes I would	
No, the site was easy to use	Yes, I would	The title font on the Home Tab could be smaller. Yellow color may cause visual effects for some users and should be replaced with a more neutral color.
Easy	Yes	

Testing Results

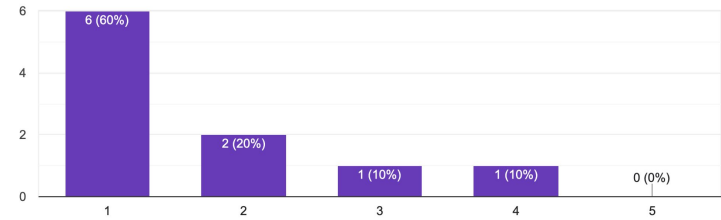
Task 1 - Find how you would start the process of creating an LLC. Question - The task was easy to accomplish

10 responses



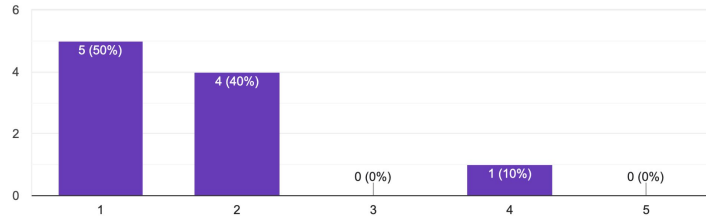
Task 2 - Find where you would go to learn more about starting a business. Question - The task was easy to accomplish

10 responses



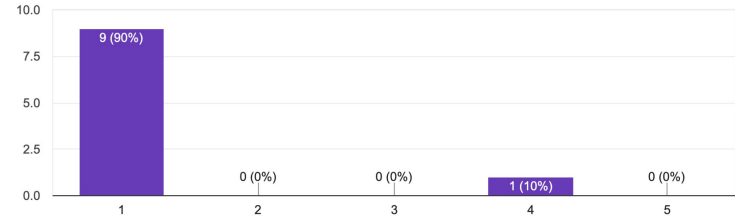
Task 3 - If you want to set up a business bank account, where/what would you click? Question - The task was easy to accomplish

10 responses



Task 4 - Show how you would switch the site from English to Spanish. Question - The task was easy to accomplish

10 responses



Future Developments

Possibilities:

- Hotline/connection with Kate (email, phone number?)
- Real AI assistant
- Multiple translations
- Workable variables (new partners, bank/personal info)
- Logo and brand identity



THANK YOU

Any Questions?